

Template files are similar to regular files in almost all respects. The sole difference is that after using a template, on saving the document, a new file with the default Excel extension is created (.xlsx). This protects the template from being overwritten by the user. If a template file needs to be modified, it again needs to be saved as a template (.xltx) by using the Save As option.

2.2 Styles

2.2.1 Cell Styles

A Cell Style is a combination of the different format options that can be applied to a cell and its contents, like Cell colour, Border, Number Formatting, Font style, Font colour etc. By defining a cell style, consisting of the different formatting options, it becomes possible to apply all of the formatting in one stroke, rather than individually.



Some Cell Style options

Under the Cell Styles drop-down, one can find the different suggested style options under the “Good, Bad and Neutral”, “Data and Model”, “Themed Cell Styles”, etc. headings. The “Good, Bad and Neutral” group lists three cell styles, besides Normal formatting—Red Font in Red Background, Green Font in Green Background, and Yellow Font in Yellow Background, labelled Bad, Good and Neutral respectively. The labelling allows those styles to be used as colour codes; for example, cells marked with the “Bad” style can convey the meaning to the user (if using the same version of Excel) that the particular cell contents met with disapproval.

Besides the suggested styles, a user can create custom styles, using “New Cell Style” in the same drop-down.